What jobs do cells do in humans?

BACKGROUND

cell membrane (say 'sell mem-brain') – the thin skin around an animal or plant cell that holds the cell together

cytoplasm (say 'site-o-plaz-em') – the main fluid substance inside a cell, which helps protect the cell's contents

The cells in humans have all sorts of jobs. For example, red blood cells carry oxygen gas around our bodies to keep our other cells working properly. There are around 200 different types of cells in the human body.

The soft **cell membrane** acts like a bag full of little holes. The cell lets some substances pass through the membrane, with some moving into the cell and some moving out of the cell. Other things are kept out completely.

☞ **1** Fill in the blanks with the correct word from the word bank.

a) The word _____ means a gas that is in the air we breathe.

b) The word _____ means tasks.

c) The word _____ means the thin skin that holds a cell together.

d) The word _____ means tiny parcels of matter that make up living things.

e) The word _____ means a device that helps us see cells and their contents.

Word bank

membrane

oxygen

microscope

jobs

cells

2 What things might a cell let in through the cell membrane?

a) nutrients and oxygen

b) waste products and carbon dioxide

c) cytoplasm and bacteria

3 What might a cell move out through the cell membrane to keep the body healthy?

a) nutrients and oxygen

b) waste products and carbon dioxide

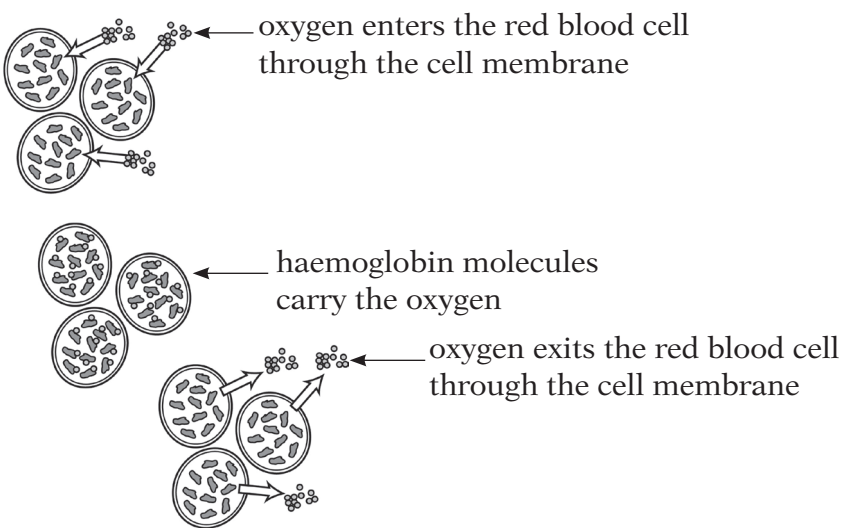
c) cytoplasm and bacteria

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What jobs do cells do in humans? CONT'D

4 Rewrite this passage about the function of red blood cells, adding in all the spaces.

Redbloodcellscarryoxygentotherestofthebody'scells.Thecellmembraneletsinoxygen, andasubstancecalledhaemoglobinholdsontoittightly.Whentheredbloodcellreaches othercells,itdeliverstheoxygenthroughthecellmembrane.



Red blood cells transport oxygen around the body.

5 What important gas do cells need to survive? _____

6 In this table, nouns (names of things) are being transformed into adjectives (describing words). Fill in the blank spaces to complete the adjectives.

Noun	Adjective
cell	cellu __ __ r
body	bodi __ __
gas	gaseo __ s
microscope	microsc __ p __ c

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